



Global AI Trend Tracker

Global Markets Research

16 April 2026

EQUITY: TECHNOLOGY

AI Expert Call #65: optical transceiver market updates

Quick Note

We hosted our AI Expert Call Series #65 today (16 April) with an expert from a leading optical communication company. The expert discussed optical transceiver market demand, pricing trend and market trend for new products such as XPO (eXtra-dense Pluggable Optics) and OCS (Optical Circuit Switch). Below, we provide our key takeaways:

Market demand for optical transceivers

- The expert estimates global demand for 800G/1.6T optical transceivers at 45-50mn/25mn+ units in 2026E, although actual shipments could be around 45mn/15mn, due to component shortages in EML chips, isolators, as well as filters.
- For 2027E, the demand for 800G/1.6T optical transceivers will be 60-70mn/40mn+ units, and the shipments will be about 55-60mn/30mn units, according to the expert.
- For 2026E, the expert estimates demand for 1.6T transceivers will mostly originate from NVIDIA [(NVDA US, Not rated), around 15mn units] and Google (GOOGL US, Not rated), around 10mn units]. For 800G transceivers, the expert estimates 2026E demand from Meta (META US, Not rated) at ~14mn units, from Amazon AWS (AMZN US, Not rated) at ~7-8mn units, from NVIDIA at ~5mn units, from Google at ~5mn units, from Oracle (ORCL US, Not rated) at ~7mn units, and from Microsoft (MSFT US, Not rated) at ~3-4mn units.

Market trend for XPO

- The 12.8T XPO solution launched by a few optical companies in OFC 2026 consists of 8 1.6T optical transceivers. Due to high power consumption, XPO module needs to be liquid cooled. The XPO module should be mostly used within the rack, while pluggable optical transceivers are still mainly used for rack-to-rack connections. The expert thinks CSPs (Cloud Service Providers) tend to use CPO (Co-Packaged Optics) and NPO (Near-field Package Optics) solutions, instead of XPO.

Prices of optical transceivers and optical chips

- The expert estimates 800G DR EML-based transceiver price at ~USD380, FR price at ~USD460, DR SiPh-based transceiver price at USD350-360, and the prices have declined by ~10% y-y in 2026, and could drop further ~10% in 2027E.
- For 1.6T optical transceivers, the expert estimates DR SiPh-based transceiver price at USD1,000-1,100 in 2026E, 1.6T DR EML-based transceiver price at USD1,100-1,200, and 1.6T FR transceiver price at about USD1,300. The price decline may be more than 10% in 2027E, due to improved yield rates, according to the expert.
- The 100G EML has risen from USD5 to ~USD7 now, and may continue to rise, according to the expert. The price of 200G EML is around USD20-25 currently.

OCS market demand

- OCS is primarily adopted by Google now, with ~18,000 units of demand in 2026E, according to the expert – about 12,000 units will be developed in-house, and the rest will be outsourced to Coherent (COHR US, Not rated) and Lumentum (LITE US, Not rated). The demand from Oracle this year is ~2,000 units, and other CSPs are still in negotiation stage. Next year the total demand may reach ~40,000 units, with Google

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accounting for ~30,000 units, according to the expert.

- NVIDIA may use a combination of OCS and CPO solutions for the next-gen dragonfly architecture, according to the expert. While CPO is mainly used in the cabinet, OCS is used outside the cabinet to establish a two-layer networking architecture, establishing an all-optical interconnection.

Appendix A-1

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